

Texas State University CS1428 - Foundations of Computer Science I (Honor)
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Semester: Fall 2025
Classroom: DERR 235
Time: Tuesday & Thursday: 11:00 am - 12:20 pm

Instructor: Dr. Ziliang Zong
Office: Comal 301 C
Phone: 512-245-8344
Email: zz11@txstate.edu
Office Hours: Tuesday & Thursday: 2:00 pm - 3:30 pm

Course Description:

An introductory course for C++ programming. Problem solving, algorithm development and analysis, structured programming, good coding style, and the control structures of C++ are emphasized. Topics include sequence, selection, repetition, functions, arrays, structures, searching and sorting. Introduction of parallel computing and basic skills on multi-core parallel programming.

Prerequisites: Math 1315

Textbook: Tony Gaddis, Starting out with C++: From Control Structures through Objects, 9th Edition

Course Evaluation:

Grades for this course will be based on:

1) Class Participation and Engagement	3%
2) Quizzes	7%
3) Labs	15%
4) Semester-Long Project	30%
5) Exam I	10%
6) Exam II	15%
7) Final Exam	20%

and will be assigned as follows:

A	B	C	D	F
Score ≥ 90	$80 \leq \text{Score} < 90$	$70 \leq \text{Score} < 80$	$60 \leq \text{Score} < 70$	Score < 60

There will be a lab every week. You must enroll in one of the lab sections associated with your lecture section.

Attendance Policy:

Attendance is required for all class sessions except documented medical emergency.

Late Policy

All deadlines are firm. No late assignments will be accepted except documented medical emergency.

Make-up policy

There will be no makeup quizzes. Since quizzes are done in class within a specific time window, I understand accidents could happen (e.g., network/computer issues, login issues, you have to miss a class, etc.). Do not worry. I will drop the three lowest quiz scores when calculating your final grade, which should cover those accidents. Makeup exams will be arranged in exceptional situations. Please notify me at least two days before the exam date and provide a verified document (e.g., Doctor's notes about your medical emergency).

Withdrawal Policy

Please follow the withdrawal and drop policy set up by the University and the College of Science. It is your responsibility to make sure the drop/withdrawal process is completed before the [deadlines](#).

Copyright

The materials provided on the Canvas course site including recorded lectures, lecture slides, assignments, handout code, and exams are protected by Copyright and for the exclusive use of students enrolled in this course. Allowing others to access this material by placing it on publicly available git repositories or submitting to “note sharing sites” such as Chegg and CourseHero (which encourage you to break the law and post copyrighted content you don’t own) is expressly forbidden. Note that you are not allowed to publicly post any of this material even if you made modifications. This copyright protection extends past the end of the semester.

Academic Integrity

It is forbidden under any circumstances whatsoever to exchange/share your code/solutions with your classmates for quizzes/homework/projects/exams, ask someone do the work for you, or copy code from others/internet. Any evidence of cheating will carry a minimum penalty of zero on the corresponding quiz/homework/project/exam and a referral to the Honor Code Council. Depending on the severity of the offense harsher penalties may apply including an F for the course. Any attempts at obtaining solutions from “note sharing sites” such as Chegg and CourseHero or hiring someone to do the work for you are considered cheating and carry the same penalty. The department regularly monitors websites for posted solutions. Please refer to the University's [Academic Honor Code](#) for more information about the academic integrity policy.

Students are permitted and encouraged to utilize AI-based tools, such as ChatGPT or similar coding assistants, to support their learning and project development. However, all work submitted must be the student’s own effort. Any AI-generated code or suggestions incorporated into assignments or projects must be thoroughly understood, appropriately adapted, and clearly acknowledged in the documentation. Submitting AI-generated work without proper comprehension or citation constitutes a violation of academic integrity. Students must be prepared to explain and defend all aspects of their submitted work. Violations of this policy will be addressed in accordance with the University's [Academic Honor Code](#), which may result in disciplinary actions including, but not limited to, failing the assignment or the course.

ADA Compliance

Please contact me during the first two weeks of classes if you have special needs or require special accommodations for your learning. You are expected to contact the office of disability services at the LBJ student center first and bring their approved disability form to me for signature. If you need special accommodations for exams, please arrange time with the office of disability services and submit official requests online at least 10 business days before the exam date.

Electronic Devices

You are encouraged to use your laptop in class for learning purpose but need to keep your cell phone/laptop muted so that they will not make sounds to interrupt the class.

Email Contact

Please only use your txstate email to contact me because your personal email (e.g. gmail or hotmail) may be automatically filtered or considered as a junk email to be deleted. Generally, I will respond to emails within 1-2 days of receiving them. If I plan to be away from my computer for more than a couple of days, I will let you know in advance.